

Physician Engagement Strategy

Building Medical Director Alignment Through the Sales Mastery Model

THE 5 PHYSICIAN HESITATION BARRIERS

1. Prognostic Uncertainty

"I can't predict exactly when they'll die." Response: Discuss the clinical criteria and that certification is about trajectory, not precision.

2. Abandonment Concerns

"Hospice means giving up." Response: Emphasize hospice as active comfort care and that you remain involved as attending.

3. Family Pressure

"The family isn't ready." Response: Offer to facilitate goals-of-care conversations; share family satisfaction data.

4. Time Constraints

"I don't have time for the paperwork." Response: Highlight that hospice handles 90% of documentation and coordination.

5. Knowledge Gaps

"I'm not sure about the criteria." Response: Provide LCD reference cards and offer brief in-service education.

APPLYING THE SALES MASTERY MODEL TO PHYSICIANS

Stage 1 - Discovery:

Learn about their patient population, referral patterns, and current hospice relationships. Ask about their experience with hospice.

Stage 2 - Connecting:

Understand their personal philosophy on end-of-life care. What matters most to them about patient outcomes?

Stage 3 - Guiding:

Present how your hospice approach aligns with their values. Share clinical protocols, outcome data, and quality metrics.

Stage 4 - Commitment:

Propose a pilot: "Would you be willing to refer 2-3 appropriate patients so you can evaluate our clinical approach?"

[TIP] CME OPPORTUNITY

Offer to sponsor or facilitate CME-eligible education on palliative care, hospice criteria, or goals-of-care conversations. This positions you as an educational partner, not just a vendor.